what was allowed under the Patriot Act. The court said federal law did not authorize the surveillance program.

International and Corporate Response

International response to the NSA's surveillance programs was widespread and frayed some diplomatic relationships with the United States. Germany opened an investigation into the tapping of Chancellor Angela Merkel's cell phone. Brazil was so outraged over NSA spying on its leaders it chose to award a large contract for fighter jets to a Swedish company instead of US company Boeing. Germany and Brazil also voiced a commitment to begin building new Internet infrastructures so Internet traffic would not have to route through the United States. On December 18, 2013, the United Nations General Assembly voted in favor of a resolution affirming online privacy as a fundamental human right.

For US technology companies such as Microsoft and Yahoo, keeping customer data safe is good for business. Conversely, it is bad for business if customers discover their data is being leaked. On December 17, 2013, a delegation of executives from telephone and Internet

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